

US Department of Agriculture (USDA)



Statement of Objectives

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Project Title

Feasibility Study on Consolidating Wildland Fire Management Operations

1.0 Purpose

The purpose of this procurement action is to complete a feasibility study that will inform decision-making regarding consolidation of wildland fire management operations. The Contractor shall provide objective, evidence-based analysis without prescribing specific solutions.

2.0 Scope or Mission

The Contractor shall conduct a comprehensive and objective feasibility study evaluating the consolidation of federal wildland fire management functions as directed by Congressional appropriations language. The study shall assess operational, financial, organizational, infrastructure and stakeholder impact of consolidating wildland fire management operations. The analysis shall evaluate both anticipated efficiencies and potential adverse impacts, including direct and indirect effects on agency mission delivery, operational readiness, and continuity of program support.

The Contractor shall identify key risks, dependencies, constraints, and mitigation strategies relevant to consolidation. The Contractor shall clearly document assumptions, limitations, data sources, and uncertainties supporting all findings and conclusions.

3.0 Period and Place of Performance

The anticipated period of performance is six (6) months from contract award.

The Contractor shall develop and maintain a project schedule that supports completion of all required deliverables within the 6-month period of performance. The Contractor shall provide regular progress updates and ensure milestone completion in accordance with the contractor developed Project Management Plan to be approved by the Contracting Officer.

At any time during the period of performance, the Government has the right to request additional briefings or progress updates to support agency leadership engagement and/or Congressional reporting requirements.

The primary place of performance for this contract is anticipated to be the Contractor's facilities. Performance may be accomplished through a combination of virtual coordination and on-site engagement as required to support stakeholder outreach, data collection, and briefings.

4.0 Background

The Secretary of Agriculture, in consultation with the Secretary of the Interior, has been directed to engage an independent, non-partisan research organization with expertise in federal land management to conduct a comprehensive study on the feasibility of consolidating wildland fire management operations as proposed in the President's budget.

5.0 Performance Objectives

The Contractor shall conduct a comprehensive and objective feasibility study evaluating the consolidation of federal wildland fire management functions as directed by Congressional appropriations language.

The study shall assess operational, financial, organizational, infrastructure and stakeholder impact of consolidating wildland fire management operations. The analysis shall evaluate both anticipated efficiencies and potential adverse impacts, including direct and indirect effects on agency mission delivery, operational readiness, and continuity of program support.

The Contractors shall identify opportunities, risks, dependencies, and mitigation strategies relevant to consolidation. The Contractor shall clearly document assumptions, limitations, data sources, and uncertainties supporting all findings and conclusions.

At a minimum, the Contractor shall address the following objectives and required areas of analysis:

- Accomplishment of agency-wide land management objectives and priority programs, such as active land management (timber & fuels targets), recreation, and ensuring the sustainability of ecosystem health to reduce long-term fire risk.
- Considerations to consolidate wildland fire management operations under a consolidated structure and the associated coordination and necessary resource-sharing.
- Cohesion necessary between wildland fire management, hazardous fuel reduction and prescribed fire programs.
- Mitigations to agency reliance of integrated workforce utilization
 - o Reliance of red-carded, non-fire personnel to meet response and fuels reduction priorities.
 - o Support of fire personnel to accomplish critical agency missions, such as recreation and timber priorities.
- Comparison of proposed consolidated service role with NIFC's current coordination functions.
- Ensuring strong and effective community and stakeholder relationships, including but not limited to, states, local governments, and Tribal entities.
- Budget execution, fiscal management, and appropriations authorities.
- Operational support functions, including but not limited to, aviation, dispatch, communications and logistics.
- Facilities, capital assets, and shared infrastructure.

6.0 Deliverables / Schedule

Contractor will be expected to develop a timeline for each of the deliverables as part of their Project Management Plan due with their proposal.

Deliverable	Description	Due Date
Project Management Plan		Upon proposal submission
Stakeholder Engagement Plan to include the Appropriations committees and other relevant Congressional committees and members		
Interim Findings Briefing		
Draft Feasibility Study Report		
Comprehensive final Feasibility Study Report with findings and recommendations		
Executive Summary Briefing suitable for Congressional and Agency Leadership		
Presentation of findings to government stakeholders		

7.0 Operating Constraints

The Contractor shall conduct the feasibility study in an objective and independent manner, providing a non-partisan analysis ensuring all findings, conclusions, and recommendations are in adherence with federal standards and supported by verifiable data, documented stakeholder input, or clearly stated analytical assumptions.

8.0 Attachments

None at this time.

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